Claims Processing and Adjudication Guide

Synthetic training document for an educational RAG project. This is not an official Aetna policy or plan document.

Claims Lifecycle

A claim is created when a provider submits information about services delivered to a member. The claim typically includes member identifiers, provider identifiers, diagnosis codes, procedure codes, service dates, billed charges, and place of service.

Validation

The claim is checked for required fields, member eligibility, provider status, duplicate submissions, coding consistency, and prior authorization requirements.

Adjudication

The adjudication process determines the allowed amount, applies network discounts and member cost sharing, and calculates plan payment and member responsibility.

Claim Adjustments

A claim may be adjusted when corrected information is submitted, a payment calculation changes, or an earlier decision is reversed.

Example Claim Adjudication

Claim ID	Billed	Allowed	Member Resp.	Plan Paid	Status
CLM-1001	$450	$280	$80	$200	Paid
CLM-1002	$1,200	$900	$250	$650	Paid
CLM-1003	$325	$0	$0	$0	Denied
CLM-1004	$780	$600	$150	$450	Adjusted